

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #021 — Phase 2, Film 6: Lead, Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

SIGNED, SEALED, DELIVERED I'M YOURS

LEAD: Stevie Wonder • RELEASE: Friday, July 15, 2016

Phase 2, Film 6 (final) • The Ant-Man role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 • approx. 145 min

A. Why Stevie Wonder

Ant-Man is a smaller, lighter heist film about a hero known for being small. He takes on a mentor's legacy, uses new technology, pulls off an impossible heist, and comes back from the edge of the quantum realm. The Motown match is **Little Stevie Wonder**. At 21 he dropped the “Little,” walked out of his childhood contract, and came back with the most artist-friendly deal Motown had ever signed.

Ant-Man	Stevie Wonder (documented history)
The small hero	“Little Stevie Wonder,” Motown's child star
Hank Pym, the mentor who passes the torch	Clarence Paul, his first producer and mentor
The heist	At 21 (May 1971) his childhood contract runs out. He walks away and comes back with creative control, a higher royalty and his own publishing
The shrinking suit (new technology)	TONTO, the giant synthesizer built by Malcolm Cecil and Robert Margouleff
The heist crew	His lawyer Johanan Vigoda, and Cecil and Margouleff
The Wasp, his partner	Syreeta Wright, his wife and co-writer
The quantum realm	The August 1973 car accident and the coma he came back from

B. Release Date: Friday, July 15, 2016

Ant-Man opened on Friday, July 17, 2015. Exactly 52 weeks later is **Friday, July 15, 2016**, closing Phase 2 in midsummer, just as the original did.

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *Signed, Sealed, Delivered I'm Yours*

It's the exact title of his 1970 hit, co-written with Syreeta Wright, Lee Garrett and his mother, Lula Mae Hardaway. It works as a pun on the contract heist at the center of the story. To the public, it's a song title (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Mark Ribowsky, <i>Signed, Sealed, and Delivered: The Soulful Journey of Stevie Wonder</i> (2010)	The main structure, 1961–1974
Stevie Wonder's documented interviews, and accounts by Malcolm Cecil and Robert Margouleff	The 1971 deal and the TONTO sessions
The master recordings, label credits, the Billboard chart record, and the Grammy record	Every song, credit and chart position, and the Album of the Year award

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: On his 21st birthday, Motown's child star walks out of the contract that has controlled his whole life, takes over a giant synthesizer, and pulls off the greatest heist in music business history: owning his own genius.

Prologue (1961–1963). An 11-year-old signs with Motown, Clarence Paul becomes his mentor, and “Fingertips” goes to #1.

Act One: The Kid Grows Up (1970–1971). “Signed, Sealed, Delivered I'm Yours” (1970) is his first self-produced hit. He marries Syreeta Wright. He's still bound by a contract signed as a child, and his earnings are held in trust.

Act Two: The Heist (1971–1972). He turns 21 in May 1971, and the contract ends. With lawyer Johanan Vigoda he walks away and pays for his own sessions with Malcolm Cecil and Robert Margouleff on TONTO in New York. Then he comes back to Motown on his own terms, with creative control, a higher royalty and his own publishing. *Music of My Mind* (1972) and *Talking Book* (1972) follow, and “Superstition” goes to #1.

Act Three: The Quantum Realm (1973–1974). *Innervisions* is released in August 1973. Three days later a car accident in North Carolina leaves him in a coma. He comes back, and in March 1974 *Innervisions* wins the Grammy for Album of the Year.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

Stevie Wonder's. He's at full strength (No-Nerf): the multi-instrumentalist, songwriter, producer and technology pioneer, with his genius shown exactly as documented and never as a gimmick.

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The childhood contract	A deal signed as a child that kept Motown in control of his music and money. Motown and Gordy are shown as documented: tough negotiators, not villains.
Tragedy	The August 1973 accident	The brush with death he comes back from, his “quantum realm.”

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	Prologue 1961–1963, then 1970 to March 1974. The fixed points are turning 21 (May 13, 1971), <i>Music of My Mind</i> and <i>Talking Book</i> (1972), the accident (Aug. 1973), and the Grammy (Mar. 1974).
Where	Detroit (Hitsville), New York (the TONTO sessions), Los Angeles (the new deal), North Carolina (the accident), and the Grammys.
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Eleven. It overlaps <i>Hitsville 3</i> and <i>Trouble Man</i> , and marks the start of the artist-control era.

7. Standalone World-Building

Stevie's world: how he hears and builds music, the TONTO studio, his marriage to Syreeta, and the lightness and humor of a heist story. It's the smallest-scale, most playful Phase 2 film, and it's complete on its own.

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in Signed, Sealed, Delivered I'm Yours
Returning	Gordy, and Stevie himself, played by the actors who played him as a child (<i>Hitsville</i> mid-credits and the Revue) and as a young songwriter (<i>The Tears of a Clown</i>). The hand-off from child to adult actor is planned (Memo #005).
Crossovers	“Fingertips” (prologue) links to <i>Hitsville 2</i> . The “Tears of a Clown” instrumental links to Smokey's film.
Plot elements	Artist control: Marvin (<i>What's Going On</i>) and Stevie both win it, which sets up Phase 3.

9. Post-Credits Scenes: Two

Scene	What happens
Mid-credits (1975)	Stevie signs a new Motown contract, reported at \$13 million, the biggest record deal of its time. It mirrors <i>Ant-Man</i> 's mid-credits reveal of the next suit: "about time."
End-credits (Los Angeles, 1975)	The Jackson brothers leave Motown for another label. Jermaine, married to Gordy's daughter Hazel, stays. The family splits over contracts and loyalty, and sides are being chosen. It sets up Phase 3, just as <i>Ant-Man</i> 's end-credits set up <i>Civil War</i> .

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 2, Film 6 of 6 (final). Released July 15, 2016.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 60% serialized / 40% standalone (Phase 2 target).
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 145 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The planned child-to-adult hand-off for Stevie, and the crossovers match <i>Hitsville 2</i> and <i>The Tears of a Clown</i> .
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a Stevie Wonder biopic, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.